



THE PLAN

Getting money into the business

Every route that is real, what each one needs, and the order to do them in.

Status labels apply throughout: KNOWN, VERIFIED, ASSUMPTION, ESTIMATE, TO VALIDATE, PROPOSED. Nothing in this document claims traction, approvals, partners or revenue that do not exist. Governing file: FACTS_BASE.

PREPARED FOR

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DATE

8 September 2026

VERSION

1.0 · Confidential draft

Every route that is real, what each one needs, and the order to do them in.

In one minute

- Every funding route on this page needs a UK-registered company. You have none. That is what is blocking you.
- Registering costs £50 and takes a week. Until it is done, you are ineligible for all of it.
- Grants are the slowest money there is. Six to twelve months from applying to cash arriving.
- The fastest money is your own time. Your own model says advisory and consulting are 59% of year three.
- Do not chase a £500,000 grant while you have no company, no customer and no clinical partner. You will not win it.

Where money actually comes from, by speed

Grants are the slowest money in the room. Your own time is the fastest.

ROUTE	CASH IN	HOW MUCH	YOU GIVE UP	HOW LIKELY TODAY
Your own time Advisory and consulting days	30-60 days	£5k-30k	None	
Discovery projects Stage A and B pilots (doc 17)	6-12 weeks	£5k-25k	None	
SBRI Healthcare NHS contract, Phase 1	6-9 months	Up to £100k	None	
NIHR i4i Connect SME development grant	6-9 months	£50k-150k	None	
Innovate UK Smart Quarterly competition	9-12 months	£100k-500k	None	
SEIS angels Equity, 50% tax relief	4-8 months	Up to £250k	You sell shares	

Every route below the top two needs a UK-registered company. You do not have one yet. That is a £50 fix and it unblocks all of them.

The top two are available now. Everything below needs the company first.

What to do

Action	Who	By when
Register the company at Companies House	You	This week
Sign the ownership agreement with David Agunede	You	This week
Sell one advisory day or one discovery project	You	Day 30
Register on the SBRI and NIHR portals, before you need them	You	Day 30
Apply for SEIS advance assurance once you have a named investor	You, then an accountant	Day 60

The blocker, said once more

You cannot register for the SBRI portal, apply to NIHR i4i, enter an Innovate UK competition, take SEIS money, open a business bank account or raise an invoice without a registered company. It is £50 and about a week. Nothing else on this page matters until it is done.

The second blocker is the ownership agreement. No grant panel and no investor will put money into software that another person publicly claims to have founded. Fix both this week.

The routes, in the order the money actually arrives

1. Your own time. Weeks, not months.

Advisory and consulting days. Your financial model has these at £867,000 of year-three revenue, which is 59% of everything. One retainer held for two years is worth about £91,000, which is more than any MaternaLink assumption inside three years.

This is not a fallback. It is the main business while the product is being built. It also needs no company registration to *sell* — only to invoice, which is another reason to register.

2. Discovery projects and staff-only trials. Six to twelve weeks.

£5,000 to £25,000 each, from private clinics and NHS innovation funds. Document 17 has the prices and the proposal template. Legal today, no certification needed, and each one produces a written evaluation you can show a grant panel.

3. SBRI Healthcare. Six to nine months.

NHS-funded development contracts, run by NHS England's Accelerated Access Collaborative. Phase 1 is up to £100,000 over six months for feasibility. Phase 2 is up to £800,000 over twelve months, and only Phase 1 winners may apply.

This is the best fit on the page. SBRI has already run competitions on Health Inequalities in Maternity Care and on Women's Health, so your subject is one they fund. It is 100% funded and you give up no shares.

What it needs: a registered company, a credible team, and an NHS partner. Register on their portal at least a week before any deadline. Check what is currently open rather than assuming.

4. NIHR i4i Connect. Six to nine months.

£50,000 to £150,000 over six to twelve months, for small companies that need a push to reach the next stage. Digital health for the NHS is explicitly in scope.

What it needs: a UK-registered SME, on Companies House **before** you apply. Fewer than 250 staff. A clinical collaborator.

5. Innovate UK Smart Grants. Nine to twelve months.

£100,000 to £500,000 for a single company, and start-ups can get up to 70% of costs covered.

Roughly quarterly rounds, each open six to eight weeks. Any sector, so competition is heavy.

What it needs: a UK-registered company, and for a pre-revenue applicant, evidence that customers actually want this. That evidence is what your discovery projects produce.

6. SEIS angel money. Four to eight months.

The Seed Enterprise Investment Scheme is how almost every first UK round gets done.

Rule	What it means
£250,000	The most the company can ever raise under SEIS, in total
50% income tax relief	An investor putting in £20,000 gets £10,000 back from HMRC
Under three years trading	The clock starts when you register. Another reason not to delay
Under £350,000 gross assets	Easy for you
Fewer than 25 employees	Easy for you

Get **advance assurance** from HMRC before you raise. It is HMRC confirming in advance that your company qualifies, and no experienced angel will write a cheque without it. HMRC takes 15 to 45 working days, and you need at least one named investor to apply. So start it two months before you need the money.

What you cannot get yet, and why

Route	Why not yet
Any grant at all	No registered company
SBRI Phase 2	You must win Phase 1 first
Venture capital	No revenue, no team, no traction. It would be a waste of both parties' time
NHS charity or trust innovation funds	Need a named clinical partner inside the trust
Research grants (NIHR programme awards)	Need a university partner and an ethics-approved protocol

None of this is permanent. Most of it is four to six months away, and all of it starts with the same £50.

Free help you are not using

Who	What they give	Cost
Health Innovation Network (your regional one)	Free support to get NHS-ready, and the usual route into SBRI	Free
NHS Clinical Entrepreneur Programme	Training and networks. Ask Dr Yusuf Shittu whether a non-clinician can get in	Free
Innovate UK Business Growth	An assigned adviser for innovative small companies	Free

Who	What they give	Cost
Your council's growth or business team	Small local grants, often a few thousand pounds, rarely competitive	Free

Use these before you pay any grant-writing consultant. Most charge 5% to 10% of what you win, and none of them can make an ineligible company eligible.

The order, on one line

Register the company, sign the ownership agreement, sell advisory days, run a paid discovery project, use that evidence to apply to SBRI and i4i, and raise SEIS money only once you can show a customer who paid.

Words explained

Word	What it means
Non-dilutive	Money that does not cost you shares. Grants and contracts are non-dilutive
SEIS	A tax scheme giving investors 50% of their money back from HMRC when they back a new British company
Advance assurance	HMRC confirming in advance that your company qualifies for SEIS, before anyone invests
Phase 1 / Phase 2	SBRI's two stages. Phase 1 proves it could work, Phase 2 builds and tests it
Gross assets	Everything the company owns, before subtracting what it owes
Retainer	A client paying a set monthly fee for ongoing advice, rather than per project